ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 4: **India's Sacred Land: Pilgrimage and Sacred Geography** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** pilgrims and merchants create demand for services	Convergence of flows
2	**(c)** it links the land with the divine body across regions	Symbolic geography
3	**(c)** Wari - Pandharpur	Sacred places
4	**(b)** cultural taboos restrict use of resources	Social protection
5	**(b)** humans across cultures revere awe-inspiring nature	Universal
6	**(d)** conservation of forests and water sources	Environmental ethic
7	**(d)** development versus cultural-ecological values	Case of Niyam Dongar
8	**(d)** place of crossing to a higher state	Both literal and symbolic
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	R gives the event that makes the place sacred.
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	The legend explains why the Mela is held at these four places.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Physical travel (1); Spiritual growth (1).	1+1
12	Protect springs (1); Hold soil (1).	1+1
13	Maximum number a place can bear (1); Avoids damage (1).	1+1
14	Life giving (1); Purification (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Taboos protect (1); Biodiversity (1); Threats of change (1).	1+1+1
16	Queues (1); Facilities (1); Technology (1).	1+1+1
17	Shared by all (1); Need protection (1); Role of community (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Predictable travellers (1); Markets (1); Roads and inns (1).	1+1+1
18	Bhudevi (1); Taboos (1); Conservation (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Cultural rights (1); Environmental rights (1); Development (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) The Wari (1). (ii) Pandharpur (1). (iii) Maharashtra (1). (iv) People of different backgrounds travel and sing together (1); sharing food and effort builds a sense of unity and shared belief (1).	1+1+1+2
20	Groves (1); Taboos (1); Niyam Dongar (1); Conflict (1); Balance (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Waste (1); Crowd control (1); Accessibility (1); Local involvement (1); Education (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Mixing up holy places and faiths: **Bodh Gaya** - Buddha's enlightenment; **Pandharpur** - Wari; **Rameswaram** - Tamil Nadu.
- Writing the wrong number of jyotirlingas; there are **12** of them, all shrines of Shiva.
- Linking the Kumbh Mela legend to a battle; it is linked to the **churning of the ocean (amrita manthana)**.
- Saying sacred groves are protected by law alone; local **belief that deities live there** protects them.
- Forgetting that sacredness is not only Indian: the **Dongria Kondh** (Niyam Dongar) and **Maori** (Taranaki Maunga) also hold mountains sacred.
- Thinking that pilgrimage is only travel; it is a journey made out of faith to a **holy place (tirtha)**.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 4: **India's Sacred Land: Pilgrimage and Sacred Geography** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** what jobs depend on pilgrim visits	Livelihood study
2	**(a)** harmony with nature	Faith in nature
3	**(b)** shared reverence across faiths	Syncretic tradition
4	**(a)** the Wari welcomes all castes	Equality
5	**(d)** the whole land is revered and interconnected	Holistic view
6	**(c)** to prevent damage to ecology and avoid accidents	Carrying capacity
7	**(b)** coexistence of traditions	Pluralism
8	**(c)** they root faith in local landscapes	Local-level belief
9	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true, but R describes what jyotirlingas are and does not explain the number twelve.
10	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	Local belief in deities residing there is why the groves are protected.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Attract devotees (1); Community life (1).	1+1
12	Destroys landscape (1); Hurts beliefs (1).	1+1
13	Taboos (1); Community care (1).	1+1
14	Visitors from all faiths (1); Respect (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Network of sites (1); Shared festivals (1); Pilgrim movement (1).	1+1+1
16	Guardians (1); Customs (1); Conflict with developers (1).	1+1+1
17	Recognition (1); Awareness (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Jobs (1); Waste (1); Pressure on resources (1).	1+1+1
18	Epics (1); Temple carving (1); Songs (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Common practices (1); Shared journey (1); Identity (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) A sacred grove (1). (ii) They believe it is the abode of a deity (1). (iii) It preserves plants, birds or water sources (1). (iv) Belief makes people care for nature and avoid damage (1); traditions passed on over generations protect biodiversity without laws (1).	1+1+1+2
20	Legend (1); Rituals (1); Scale (1); Management (1); Recognition (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Wari (1); Sabarimala (1); Songs (1); Equality (1); Hardship (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Mixing up holy places and faiths: **Bodh Gaya** - Buddha's enlightenment; **Pandharpur** - Wari; **Rameswaram** - Tamil Nadu.
- Writing the wrong number of jyotirlingas; there are **12** of them, all shrines of Shiva.
- Linking the Kumbh Mela legend to a battle; it is linked to the **churning of the ocean (amrita manthana)**.
- Saying sacred groves are protected by law alone; local **belief that deities live there** protects them.
- Forgetting that sacredness is not only Indian: the **Dongria Kondh** (Niyam Dongar) and **Maori** (Taranaki Maunga) also hold mountains sacred.
- Thinking that pilgrimage is only travel; it is a journey made out of faith to a **holy place (tirtha)**.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 4: **India's Sacred Land: Pilgrimage and Sacred Geography** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** donations or trade at the site	Economic link
2	**(c)** it spreads the sacred geography and lets many regions host it	Distribution
3	**(b)** travel accounts and inscriptions	Historical evidence
4	**(d)** it builds respect and responsible behaviour	Awareness
5	**(b)** the practice of Wari singing	Living tradition
6	**(b)** rivers are central to daily and sacred life	Social space
7	**(c)** collecting only fallen twigs, not cutting trees	Sustainable use
8	**(d)** respect for nature as divine	Care
9	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A is false, Niyam Dongar is sacred to the Dongria Kondh; R is true.
10	**(c)** A is true but R is false.	A is true; R is false, Pandharpur is in Maharashtra.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Modernisation (1); Loss of practice (1).	1+1
12	Stampedes (1); Waste (1).	1+1
13	Create a shared map (1); Memory (1).	1+1
14	Awareness (1); Cleaning drives (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	All castes (1); Abhangs (1); Shared meals (1).	1+1+1
16	Speed (1); Comfort (1); Loss of austerity (1).	1+1+1
17	Income (1); Awareness (1); Commercialisation (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Scale (1); Rituals (1); Management (1).	1+1+1
18	Life vs permanence (1); Rituals (1); Pilgrimages (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Rituals (1); Waste (1); Clean-up (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) The Dongria Kondh (1). (ii) Taranaki Maunga (1). (iii) New Zealand (1). (iv) Many communities see mountains and nature as sacred (1); this reverence leads them to protect these places (1).	1+1+1+2
20	Ajmer (1); Velankanni (1); Bodh Gaya (1); Golden Temple (1); Lessons (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Stupas (1); Temples (1); Inscriptions (1); Scholars (1); Languages (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Writing the wrong number of jyotirlingas; there are **12** of them, all shrines of Shiva.
- Linking the Kumbh Mela legend to a battle; it is linked to the **churning of the ocean (amrita manthana)**.
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